



Copy of Maximus Master Release Documentation and Guidelines

📘 Purpose: This page defines the standard master release process for Maximus products and shared services. It covers scope, release principles, ownership, release flow, mandatory gates, evidence requirements, rollback expectations, deployment controls, and environment deployment references.

⚠️ Applies to: All Maximus products and shared services included in a master release train. No product may bypass shared quality, security, approval, or rollback requirements.

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Overview

This guide is the operational reference for planning, validating, approving, and deploying a Maximus master release across products, shared services, and environments. It is intended for Release Managers, Product Release Owners, QA leads, Tech Leads, DevOps, SRE, and business sign-off stakeholders.

A master release must ensure synchronized promotion, consistent evidence, traceable versions, approved exceptions, and clear rollback readiness across the full release train.

Purpose and Scope

This guide applies to **all Maximus products and shared services** included in a master release train.

- **Business coverage:** All in-scope product lines and journeys participating in the release
- **Technical coverage:** All affected repositories under the Bitbucket project **MAX**
- **Environment coverage:** SIT, QA, Sandbox, UAT, Pre-Prod, and Production, plus hotfix lanes using SIT1, QA1, and Sandbox1 where applicable

Release paths:

Master Release follows **SIT → QA → Sandbox → UAT → Pre-Prod → Prod.**

Hotfix Release follows **SIT1 → QA1 → Sandbox1 → UAT → Pre-Prod → Prod.**

Release Principles and Tag Governance

Core Release Principles

- Release sequence is mandatory: **SIT/SIT1 → QA/QA1 → SB/SB1 → UAT → Pre-Prod → Production**
- In a master release, no product can bypass shared quality gates
- No deployment without approvals
- No release without regression evidence
- No unresolved critical security risk at go-live
- No production promotion without required QA and UAT sign-offs, vulnerability closure, and rollback readiness
- Release notes must include impacted products, shared services, versions, reports, owners, and rollback plan

Release Tag Governance

Release Type	Purpose	Tag Format
Maximus Master release	Planned train release across products and shared services	x.0.0 (example: 76.0.0)
Maximus Hotfix release	Critical bug, security, or compliance fix with high urgency	x.1.0 (example: 76.1.0)

Planned independent release	Non-master planned release for isolated product scope	x.0.1 (example: 76.0.1)
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Roles and Ownership

Role	Primary Ownership	Expected Output
Release Manager / Master Release Owner	Release timeline, dependency management, go/no-go orchestration, final communication	Approved release plan, governance decisions, closure communication
Product Release Owners	Product scope, risk register, sign-off readiness	Product readiness confirmation and risk visibility
Tech Leads	Change readiness, version traceability, config and secret changes, deployment validation	Technical deployment readiness and traceable artifacts
QA Leads	Smoke, regression, backward compatibility evidence, defect disposition	QA sign-off and evidence package
UAT / Business SPOCs	Business validation and UAT sign-off	Explicit product-wise UAT approval or accepted risk
DevOps / Build Owner / SRE	Pipeline execution order, promotion flow, monitoring gates, rollback support	Controlled deployment execution and operational support

End-to-End Release Flow

1. Plan and freeze

- Confirm release train scope across all products
- Lock release calendar slot and branch strategy
- Publish SPOC matrix for Dev, QA, UAT, BA, Release, and DevOps
- Enforce code cut-off; common service cut-off exceptions require explicit approval

2. SIT cut and quality gates

- Cut release branches as per process
- Auto-promote SIT build to QA for smoke and regression
- Run QA cycle with a 9-day cap and mandatory backward compatibility checks

3. Sandbox and Pre-Prod progression

- Target Day-5 push to Sandbox
- Freeze QA pipelines after accepted QA build
- Freeze Sandbox after promotion
- Validate journeys, contract compatibility, and dependency behavior

4. UAT sign-off

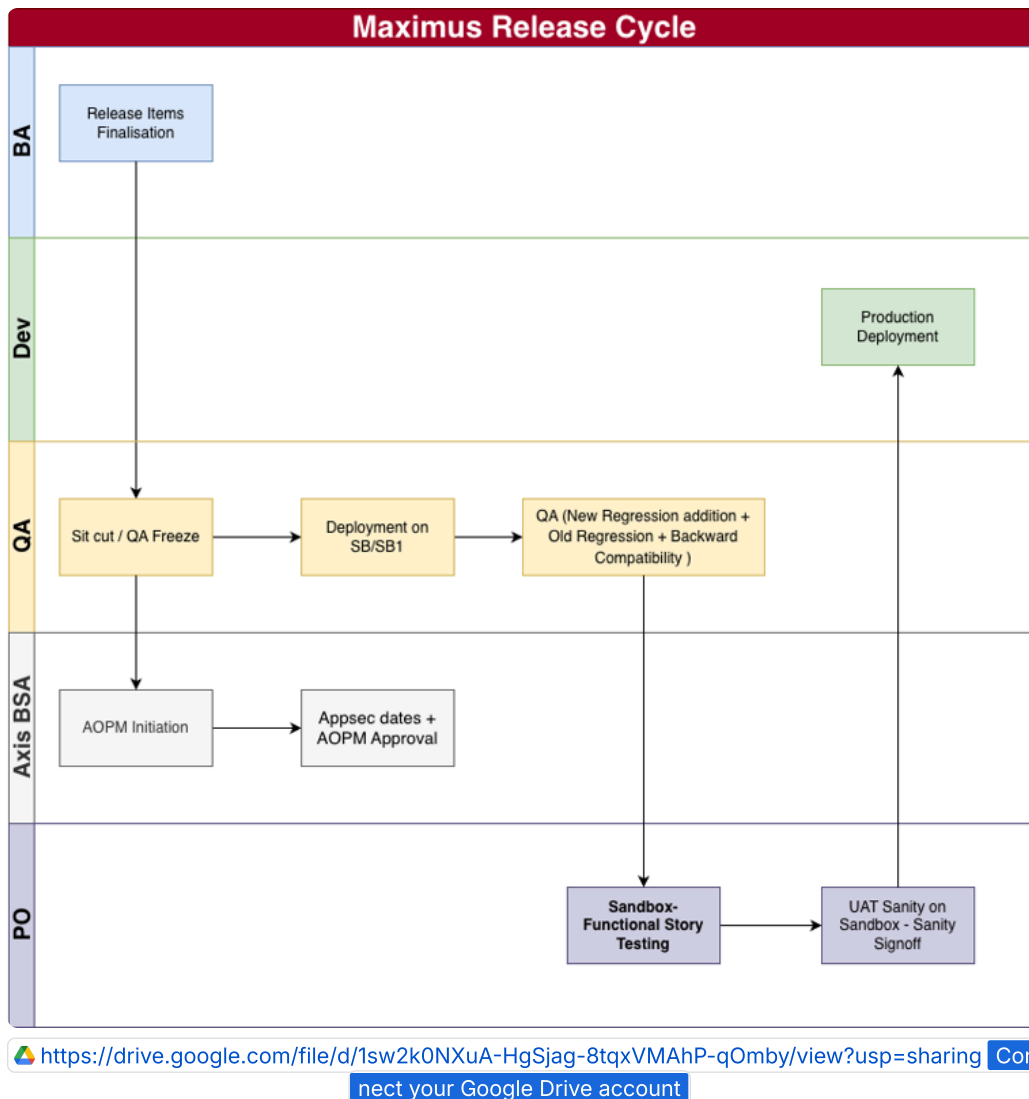
- Complete PO sanity window with a target of 3 days
- Publish product-wise evidence package
- Capture explicit UAT sign-off or approved risk acceptance

5. Production readiness gate

- Verify vulnerabilities, config and secrets sync, deployment sequence, rollback assets, and AOPM approval status

6. Production deployment and closure

- Deploy in approved release window
- Validate post-deploy smoke and monitoring
- Publish closure note and known issues



Stage Timeline Targets

Stage	Target Window	Outcome
Cut-off and branch readiness	Day 0	Release scope frozen and branches prepared
QA functional, regression, and BC checks	Day 1-4	Validated build with evidence
Sandbox promotion target	Day 5	Promotion candidate stabilized
PO and UAT validation	Day 6-8	Business validation completed

Final QA sign-off and production readiness review	Day 9	Go/no-go decision prepared
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Mandatory Checklists and Release Controls

Global Release Checklist

- ☐ Scope matrix finalized and approved
- ☐ Release notes page created or updated in Confluence
- ☐ Vulnerability status reviewed for all in-scope repositories
- ☐ Shared and common service dependency checks completed
- ☐ Deployment sequence and rollback owners published
- ☐ Seed branch cut completed for current release + 1 and verified with Build COP
- ☐ Back-office seed branch cut completed for current release + 1 and verified with Build COP
- ☐ `maximus-dlp-helm` diff review completed between current release and target release
- ☐ `secret-config.txt` review completed, including whitespace and trailing-line hygiene

Product Readiness Checklist

- ☐ Product service, UI, and test repositories identified
- ☐ Planned version to commit and build mapping completed
- ☐ Config, toggle, and secret changes documented
- ☐ Smoke, regression, and backward compatibility evidence attached
- ☐ Open defects triaged with release decision

Platform and Shared Services Checklist

- ☐ Helm, config, and seed changes validated in target environment
- ☐ Shared services such as identity, auth, backoffice, and common services verified for compatibility
- ☐ API contract compatibility reviewed for producer and consumer impact
- ☐ Monitoring dashboards and alert thresholds validated

Release Manager Final Gate

- ☐ QA sign-off captured for all products in scope
- ☐ UAT sign-off captured for all products in scope
- ☐ Go/no-go decision logged with timestamp and approvers
- ☐ Post-release communication issued
- ☐ Teams call for release window created in advance

Mandatory Approvals and Governance Gates

- QA sign-off from QA Head or delegate
- IT approval
- Security or InfoSec approval
- Product Owner sign-off

- AOPM multi-level approval from L2-L5 as applicable

❌ **Hard stop:** Production go-live must be blocked if required approvals, regression evidence, backward compatibility evidence, security treatment, or rollback readiness are incomplete.

Mandatory Release Evidence, Rollback, and Exceptions

Evidence Required for Every In-Scope Product

- Service and UI versions deployed
- Smoke test report links
- Regression test report links
- Backward compatibility status
- Known issues, waivers, and mitigations
- Rollback notes and owner
- QA and UAT sign-offs

Rollback Guideline

- Keep rollback artifact or tag ready for each in-scope product
- Define rollback triggers such as critical journey failure, sustained error rate, data inconsistency, or severe security issue
- Assign rollback executor and approver per product and shared service
- Record exact rollback pipeline or command and post-rollback validation checks
- Document reversibility for override image or pod patch changes where temporary patching is used

Exception Handling and Edge Cases

- **Missed cut-off for product-only service:** Move to next planned release unless exception is approved
- **Missed cut-off for common service:** Release remains blocked unless a time-boxed extension is approved by release governance
- **Missing hotfix merge into master release branch:** Block go-live until merge or reconciliation is complete
- **Open high or critical security findings:** Block production go-live unless approved risk treatment exists
- **Incomplete regression or backward compatibility evidence:** Block production promotion

Operational Deployment Controls and Environment References

Common Operational Controls

- Trigger and validate common service builds from approved branch strategy
- Freeze and unfreeze QA and Sandbox pipelines only through Release Owner and Build COP control
- Keep the release Confluence page current with every environment promotion

Patching Controls

- Use approved self-service patching flow for temporary override patches in QA, PERF, and Sandbox
- Validate pod image versions before and after patch
- Record reason, owner, start time, and rollback time for each patch

Deployment Sequence

1. Execute release foundation pipelines, including all-release and shared platform flows
2. Promote seed and back-office seed paths as per release gate
3. Trigger product all-release pipelines in approved batches, in parallel only where safe

Vulnerability Dashboard

Non-Prod Environment Vulnerability Dashboard: [Spring Boot Upgrade Dashboard](#)

1. Access the dashboard URL
2. Select **Group by Service Name** in view mode
3. Expand the target service and review the grace period and applicable CVEs
4. Plan and complete remediation before the grace period ends

Checking Smokes Before SIT Cut or QA Freeze

1. Log in to Jenkins: [Maximus Jenkins](#)
2. Navigate to Maximus_916_NonProd -> sit -> Master Deploy / Master Release
Smoke
3. Review each service pipeline and confirm successful smoke test execution

Environment Deployment References

Open product-wise Jenkins deployment links

Product	SIT / SIT1	QA / QA1	Sandbox / SB1	UAT	Pre-Prod
Commons	SIT , SIT1	QA , QA1	SB , SB1	UAT	Prod

Personal Loan (PL)	SIT	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod
Business Loan (BL)	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Home Loan (HL)	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Auto Loan	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Credit Card (CC)	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	Sandbox, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Working Capital	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
LAS	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
ODSAL	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Forex	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod, All Release
Tractor Loan	SIT, SIT1	QA, QA1	SB, SB1	UAT	Prod

▼ Recommended release note minimum fields

- Release tag and release type
- In-scope products and shared services
- Repository and version mapping
- Environment promotion history
- Smoke, regression, and backward compatibility evidence links
- Approvals and sign-off status
- Known issues and accepted risks
- Rollback owner and rollback method
- Final go/no-go decision and closure summary

